

Richmond Regional Heirs' Property Study



Locality Fact Sheet: Richmond City

Analysis by HDAvisors in support of the [Richmond Heirs Property Network](#), 2026.

This sheet summarizes the heirs' property indicators found across Richmond City's parcels, read from public records. The result is a regional screen identifying parcels with an elevated risk of being an heirs' property, not a legal determination of title. The numbers below show how many parcels were flagged, how they compare to the rest of the local parcel stock, and where in Richmond City they cluster.

FLAGGED PARCELS

1,892

of 76,757 parcels

SHARE OF PARCEL STOCK

2.46%

study area 2.12%

CONFIDENCE TIERS

363 / 1,529

high confidence / likely

CLUSTER TRACTS

3 hot / 0 cold

of 75 census tracts

Flagged Parcels vs. All Parcel Stock

Richmond City

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$237,000	\$327,000
Median build year	1947	1948
USPS vacancy, known status	13.13%	2.18%

Study Area for Comparison

8,091 flagged of 381,852 parcels

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$245,700	\$329,000
Median build year	1965	1981
USPS vacancy, known status	9.55%	1.03%

Ownership Signals

Share of flagged parcels carrying each signal

Explicit estate language		1.3%
Deceased owner of record		73.0%
Long tenure		76.4%
Absentee owner		59.2%
Out-of-state owner		6.2%

Selected signals are shown. Parcels can carry more than one signal, so percentages do not sum to 100%.

Property Type Mix

Share of flagged parcels by type

Occupied family home		62.5%
Multi-owner absentee home		17.3%
Empty lot		8.3%
Vacant house		11.9%

Vacancy is the share of parcels with a known USPS vacancy status. Parcels with no status on record are excluded from the denominator. In Richmond, most parcels without a recorded status are lots without buildings, which often lack a deliverable address.

Property types are groupings of statistically similar parcels. No single trait defines membership.

Hot- and cold-cluster tracts have flagged-parcel rates statistically above or below the regional pattern. Tracts with fewer than 5 heirs-flagged parcels or fewer than 100 total parcels are not assigned a rate class. 4 of 75 tracts here are below that threshold.

High confidence indicates stronger, converging heirs' property evidence. Likely indicates meaningful but less conclusive evidence. Both are classifications, not legal determinations of heirs' property status.

Data Sources: ReGrid parcel records, Q1 2026; U.S. Census Bureau, "2024 ACS 5-Year Estimates Detailed Tables," 2024, <https://api.census.gov/data/2024/acs/acs5>, accessed June 9 2026.

How Richmond Differs from the Study Area

Share of flagged parcels

	RICHMOND	STUDY AREA
Deceased owner of record	73.0%	81.7%
Absentee owner	59.2%	45.7%
Occupied family home	62.5%	69.4%
Vacant house	11.9%	8.6%

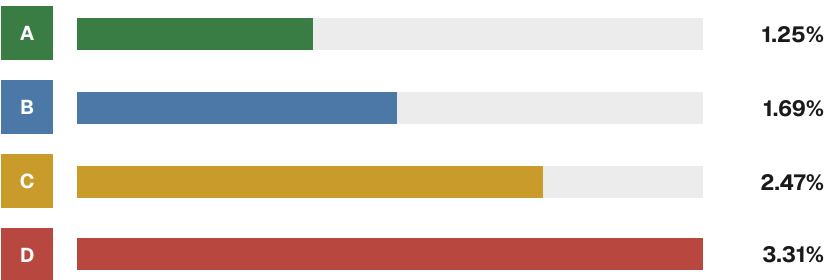
USPS vacancy is much more common among Richmond's flagged parcels than across the city's parcel stock.

13.13%
Flagged

2.18%
All stock

Historical Impact of Redlining

Flagged-parcel rates rise across the four historical Home Owners' Loan Corporation grades, from 1.25% in grade A areas to 3.31% in grade D areas.



This gradient does not mean a historical grade independently determines where flagged properties are found today. The pattern is consistent with redlining's continuing influence through the unequal geography it helped produce.

Assessed Property Value

Richmond's 1,892 flagged parcels represent a substantial share of property value while remaining homes, lots, and ownership interests rather than a single kind of asset.

TOTAL ASSESSED VALUE

\$559.3M

across flagged parcels with positive values

MEDIAN ASSESSED VALUE

\$237,000

among Richmond's flagged parcels

Nelson, R. K., Winling, L., et al. (2023). *Mapping Inequality: Redlining in New Deal America*. Digital Scholarship Lab. <https://dsl.richmond.edu/panorama/redlining/>
Total assessed value accounts for multi-lot parcel groups and includes parcels with positive assessed values. Assessed value is not market value, homeowner equity, or value lost.

The Study Area includes Richmond City, Petersburg, Hopewell, Colonial Heights, Chesterfield County, and Henrico County.

Comparisons use the 8,091 flagged parcels across the Study Area. Vacancy rates are calculated only among parcels with a known USPS vacancy status. In Richmond, most parcels without a recorded status are lots without buildings, which often lack a deliverable address.